

1,000 acres of forest in Ballari...

Forest, from Jacket Page 2

While Hemant reasoned that the extent of 'kharab' (waste/ revenue) land was not mentioned in the right row in Column 3 of RTCs and hence needed correction, a review of the old RTCs obtained from the Bhoomi portal of the Revenue Department shows that the RTCs pertaining to the four survey numbers had no such errors.

"The assistant commissioner neither called the forest officer concerned to verify claims, nor seek an opinion from the department. He just issued an ex parte order which kept the department in the dark," a senior officer from the forest department told *DH*, noting that ex parte orders have been ruled as void as they violate principles of natural justice. In fact, if the officer really wanted to correct the RTC, he should have put the forest department in column 9 (owner) from the column 10 (custodian) after verifying the notifications and documents.

Kallahalli said the issue was a clear indication of a conspiracy to illegally divert forest land. "This is a case where a revenue officer has gone out of his way to convert a forest land into revenue land so that it can be allotted to a major industry. The CBI should probe the conspiracy. The role of the forest department should also be verified in this matter," he added.

To a question, Ballari Deputy Conservator of Forests Basavaraja K N, who took over the post after the incident, said the department has written to the revenue department in the matter.

"The assistant conservator of forests Ballari has written to assistant commissioner for mutation of 9,637 hectares of notified forest land in favour of the department. This includes the said four survey numbers of Soamalapura Reserve Forest," he said, adding that his office has followed up the matter in May. Sources in the revenue department said the "mistakes" will be corrected. "The matter has been brought to the notice of the department. The corrections will happen within a week," a senior official told *DH*.

Rahul calls Haldwani...

Rahul, From PJ2

"Untouchability was made illegal. BJP people are openly practising untouchability. When they carry out 'purification', they are saying Dalits should not be touched, that Dalits are dirty," Rahul said.

Rahul's remarks came days after Uttarakhand BJP chief Mahesh Bhatt defended the purification ceremony at Ramilla maidan in Haldwani where Kharge addressed a rally on Aug 10. Kharge had raised the issue in Rajya Sabha, following which leader of the House J P Nadda said BJP did not subscribe to it and would probe it.

"We demand that an FIR be lodged... Narendra Modi says he belongs to every caste and is PM of the country, but his party chief of Uttarakhand defends 'shuddhikaran'. It is RSS people who did it, and the PM should order an FIR under SC/ST Act against these people," he said, adding the Uttarakhand BJP chief won't be able to escape.

When asked about Kharge making his unhappiness clear over party leaders not supporting him on the issue at a recent Congress Working Committee meeting, Rahul said the Congress president did not in any way say the vast majority of Congress people did not support him.

"He said certain people did not support him... I supported him. A whole number of other people supported him. He was pointing to a set of people whom he felt did not support him. But frankly, let me tell you, and I have spoken to Kharge-ji about this. This is not Kharge-ji's issue alone. This is an issue for every Dalit person in India." Emphasising that the battle is between the Constitution and the ideology of BJP-RSS, Rahul said it is the duty of the union and Uttarakhand governments to ensure that Kharge gets justice.

Will give new shape to Dasara, make it more attractive: CM

'Kambala in Mysuru without harming environment'

MYSURU, DHNS

Chief Minister D K Shivakumar said on Saturday that he planned to give a new shape to Mysuru Dasara as per changing times and make it more attractive with new innovations and events. "I have already discussed this with Mysuru DC G Lakshmi kanth Reddy and officials of the department of Kannada and Culture. I will hold another meeting soon," CM told reporters here.

The CM said, "Dasara has its own tradition. While continuing that, we have to give prominence to new thoughts and ideas of new generation. We plan to portray our defence forces; make torchlight parade and illumination more innovative. We have communicated to Karnataka Film Chamber of Commerce to ensure participation of sandalwood artistes in a tableau during Dasara procession.

They participated in the procession earlier and it was discontinued. We will avoid repetition of folk art forms and performance of same artistes every year. The procession will have to meet high standards, discontinuing the practice of Dasara committee members marching along."

Even as some people have proposed to reduce scale of Dasara owing to drought, CM said it could not be scaled down, as many people depend on the tourism and hospitality industry. As stakeholders of the hotel and tourism industries benefit, they should help the district administration in making the festivities more attractive."

He said, "Kambala will be held during Dasara, without spoiling the environment. I will discuss if they are cutting trees and wasting water, instead of doing it in a farm field. It's no prestige issue for me".



Chief Minister D K Shivakumar seeks blessings of Suttur Mutt seer at the Jayanti Mahotsav of Shivarathri Rajendra Swami, in Mysuru on Saturday. DH PHOTO/ANUP RAGH T

Hanur shootout

Regarding the Hanur shootout, Shivakumar said, "The Kollegal assistant commissioner has submitted a magisterial report. It has details about why the suspected poachers entered the forest and what they carried. It has been handed over to the CID. They are investigating in detail. We will initiate action once the CID gives its report".

5 cities to be developed to decongest Bengaluru

Shivakumar said, in order to reduce the pressure on Bengaluru, the government planned to develop five cities, including Kalaburagi, Belagavi and Hubballi-Dharwad, to create job opportunities on the lines of Bengaluru, and provide better health, education and other facilities.

The CM said he signed a proposal recently, to develop ring roads in all cities -big and small - to avoid

entry of outside vehicles inside and reduce traffic pressure, he said.

On Greater Mysuru notification, the CM said, "Former CM Siddaramaiah has already come up with plans with a vision to give a new shape to his home district Mysuru. I will bring all of them to reality. I will implement all works and programmes he had already taken up. Compared

to other cities, Mysuru is better planned," he said.

He said, even as people travel from Mysuru to Kengeri in one and half hours, they struggle for one and half hours in traffic from Kengeri to Bengaluru.

The Mysuru MLAs had drawn his attention to it, the chief minister said, adding that he would plan to resolve the issue.

Major IPS reshuffle; 16 officers transferred

BENGALURU, DHNS

The government on Saturday ordered a major reshuffle of IPS officers, transferring 16 senior police officers with immediate effect.

ADGP Harishekanan P, currently heading Crimes and Technical Services, has been transferred as ADGP, Directorate of Civil Rights Enforcement.

R Srinivas Gowda, SP, Bengaluru south district (Ram nagara), has been posted as DCP, city crime branch-I, while Rohan Jagadeesh, SP, Gadag, has been transferred as SP, Bengaluru south district. Shiva Prakash Devaraju has been posted as SP, Anti Narcotics Task Force, and Dr Shivakumar as SP, Karnataka Lokayukta. ADGP M Nanjundaswamy has been transferred ADGP, Grievances and Human Rights. Devajyoti Ray has been posted as ADGP, Crimes and Technical Services. Among other key

appointments, IG Amit Singh has been transferred from Western Range, Mangaluru, and posted as IG, Karnataka State Reserve Police. R Chethan, who was awaiting posting, will take charge as DIG, Western Range, Mangaluru.

Belagavi City Police Commissioner Borase Bhushan Gulabrao has been transferred as DIG and Commissioner of Police, Hubballi-Dharwad. Nikam Prakash Amrit has been posted DIG and Commissioner of Police, Belagavi City. Padmini Sahoo, DCP (Administration), Bengaluru, has been transferred as Superintendent of Police, Chikkaballapur. Kushal Chouksey, who was SP, Chikkaballapur, will take charge as DCP (Administration), Bengaluru. Sahil Bagla, DCP, Traffic East Division, Bengaluru, has been transferred as SP, Koppal, while Mithun H N, DCP (Law and Order), Mangaluru City, will take charge as SP, Gadag.

BJP to proceed with padayatra

BENGALURU, DHNS: BJP has decided to go ahead with its Ballari Padayatra, scheduled from September 1 from Lingasugur and to be concluded in Ballari on September 10, through nine Assembly constituencies.



Sriramulu

Former minister B Sriramulu in a press meet here on Saturday said that Union Ministers Pralhad Joshi and H D Kumaraswamy, BJP state president B Y Vijayendra, Leader of Opposition R Ashoka, Legislative Council Opposition Leader Chalavadi Narayanaswamy and several other leaders would take part in the inauguration of the march.

"It will pass through Maski, Sindhanur, Karatagi, Gangavathi, Kampli, Sandur and Ballari Rural constituencies before concluding in Ballari City," he said.

Car-free day, tech park shuttles proposed on congested ORR

Traffic, From PJ2

He stressed that the city needs better pavements and regular public buses first before asking people to leave their cars at home.

"It could catch on naturally as people see others doing it. It is a good idea, but you can't force it. The campaign must be driven consciously, with all companies involved and clear messaging," he added.

Srinivas Alavilli, a Fellow at WRI India, told *DH* that Car-Free Days are a practical way to show that reducing vehicles is the most effective approach to lowering congestion and pollution. He said that while Whitefield and Electronics City already have metro access, the ORR is still waiting for the

Blue Line.

However, he noted that commuters can take the Purple Line to KR Puram or the Yellow Line to Silk Board and switch to BMTC buses to reach the tech parks, a route many already use. Since many ORR commuters live in the Sarjapur Road-Haralur belt, he added that running additional buses would significantly support the initiative.

Citing a similar model, he mentioned that Mumbai's financial district, Bandra Kurla Complex, has been running a "Friday Public Transport Day" campaign since June 2026 with corporate support. He noted that this effort has expanded bus services, prompted studies to improve last-mile connectivity and walkability.

Regarding potential overcrowding, he explained that because the proposal allows companies to pick any day of the month, a sudden rush is unlikely and even if it happens, BMTC can handle the demand. He also noted that existing inter-campus shuttles at major tech parks are unlikely to face extra strain.

He also emphasised that traffic police and parking data can easily measure the project's impact, providing insights into travel patterns on the ORR until the Blue Line opens. He added that the ongoing Corporate Commute Nudge programme at Biocon in Electronics City proves employees are willing to switch to public transport if companies encourage them.

Facial authentication for Gruha Lakshmi beneficiaries

BENGALURU, PTI

The government will undertake re-verification of beneficiaries registered under the Gruha Lakshmi Scheme through biometric and facial authentication to identify eligible beneficiaries, officials said on Saturday.

An order to this effect was issued on August 28 after a detailed examination of the proposal submitted to the government seeking Cabinet approval, they said.

The door-to-door re-verification of beneficiaries under the scheme will commence from August 30, with the exercise to be completed within a month, officials said.

"In view of the matters explained in the proposal, administrative approval is hereby accorded for re-verification of beneficiaries registered under the Gruha Lakshmi Scheme through biometric/ facial authentication to identify eligible beneficiaries," the government order said.

According to the order, the re-verification will be undertaken to remove currently ineligible beneficiaries from the scheme.

The process will be implemented through a web application/mobile application developed by the Directorate of Electronic Delivery of Citizens Services (EDCS), it said.

"Verification shall be carried out through door-to-door surveys as well as at Grama One, Karnataka One, Bengaluru One and CSC (Bapuji Seva Kendras)," the order said.

The verification process under the Gruha Lakshmi Scheme that would be undertaken within a grant limit of Rs 20 crore will be carried out in accordance with the Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) approved by Chief Minister D K Shivakumar, the order said.

The Department of Women and Child Development has

been tasked with overseeing the re-verification process, for which a detailed SOP has been issued while the e-Governance Department will provide the necessary technical and operational support.

According to the SOP, beneficiaries will be visited at their homes and provided printed enumeration forms, which they will have to fill and return. If a beneficiary is not present, another family member can fill out the form.

The government has made household visits, distribution and collection of enumeration forms mandatory, stating that visits cannot be avoided even if the required information is available through other sources or verification methods.

Enumerators will use a designated mobile application containing village-wise and urban-area-wise lists of Gruha Lakshmi beneficiaries. Photographic evidence will be captured against the beneficiary's name during the visit, while the application will automatically record the GPS coordinates of the beneficiary's residence, it said.

The SOP states that beneficiaries who are not available during the household visit and cannot complete facial authentication will be informed through multiple communication channels and asked to complete biometric authentication at their assigned Fair Price Shop or the nearest Karnataka One, Grama One or Bengaluru One centre.

The government has also decided to use biometric authentication data already collected at Fair Price Shops.

For implementing the exercise, Deputy Commissioners and Chief Executive Officers of Zilla Panchayats have been directed to mobilise existing Guarantee Committee members and identify the required number of enumerators, the SOP said.

Over 500 fake doctors...

Quacks, From PJ2

Many of them were not qualified, a few others were qualified but not registered under the Karnataka Private Medical Establishments (KPME) Act, and a few others were qualified as doctors through other degrees like Bachelor of Ayurvedic Medicine and Surgery (BAMS) or Bachelor of Homeopathic Medicine and Surgery (BHMS) but did not disclose it to patients and instead practiced like an allopathy doctor.

Health and Family Welfare Minister U T Khader told *DH* that the department was now preparing an action plan to intensify crackdown on such clinics. "I have asked officials to prepare a report with the details of such establishments at taluk level. We will

prepare an action plan and implement it soon. We will also hold discussions with the police department and seek their support to intensify the crackdown," Khader said.

After 582 fake doctors were identified, the 582 clinics run by them have been shut down. A fine has been imposed on 87 of the fake doctors while judicial proceedings are underway against 29 others.

Experts, however, opined that there is a need to strengthen government healthcare infrastructure to ensure that people have access to medical facilities and this will in turn curb operation of such fake doctors. "We have also received such feedback. We are expanding our network and we are reaching the remote corners as well," another health department official said.

Reservoir storage and flow data

Reservoirs	Total capacity*	Present storage (in tmcft)	Inflow (cusec)	Outflow (cusec)
Krishna basin				
Almatti	123.08	122.66	26883	21049
Tungabhadra	105.79	96.42	11574	8905
Bhadra	71.54	61.05	4686	207
Hidkal	51	51.00	4729	2795
Malaprabha	37.73	22.42	1097	2218
Narayanpura	33.31	33.17	25082	25082
Vanivilas Sagar	30.42	22.25	0	580
Cauvery basin				
Harangi	8.5	8.42	4099	3125
Hemavathi	37.10	29.50	2173	5500
KR Sagar	49.45	30.03	7955	6872
Kabini	19.52	12.63	4993	8260

* in tmcft

♦ WEATHER ♦

Overview: Rainfall occurred at most places over Coastal; at a few places over South Interior and at isolated places over North Interior Karnataka.

Forecast Aug 30: Generally cloudy sky. Light to moderate rain likely in some areas.

INTERIOR NORTH				
Stations	Max	Min	Rain (mm)	
Belagavi	28.0	20.6	0.3	
Bidar	33.0	21.4	0.0	
Vijayapura	33.5	20.5	0.0	
Dharwad	29.0	20.0	tr	
Kalaburagi	35.4	22.2	0.0	
Raichur	34.4	22.2	0.0	
COASTAL				
Honnavar	30.5	24.0	20.1	
Karwar	32.2	25.4	3.8	
Shirali	NA	NA	NA	
Mangaluru	29.8	25.6	12.0	

INTERIOR SOUTH				
Stations	Max	Min	Rain	
Angumbe	25.1	21.4	41.5	
Bengaluru	28.2	20.2	3.3	
Ballari	NA	NA	NA	
Chamarajanagar	--	--	--	
Chikkamagaluru	--	--	--	
Chitradurga	28.9	21.6	0.0	
Davangere	28.5	20.0	0.0	
Hassan	--	--	--	
Mysuru	29.6	19.0	0.8	
Madikeri	--	--	--	
Kolar	31.0	20.2	0.0	
OTHER STATIONS				
New Delhi	35.0	27.0	NIL	
Kolkata	31.0	27.0	NIL	
Mumbai	31.0	27.0	NA	
Chennai	35.0	28.0	NA	
Pune	28.0	23.0	NA	
Hyderabad	28.0	23.0	NA	
Thirupuram	30.0	26.0	NIL	